

Fundamental Rights, DPSPs & Their Interplay

Articles, restrictions, enforceability contrasts and landmark harmony doctrine.

Portion focus ~48% · Topic: polity-const

PYQ themes: FR articles · DPSP · Reasonable restrictions · Harmony doctrine

Why UPSC asks this

Constitutional rights are the densest Prelims polity block every year.

FR map for speed

Group rights: equality, freedom, exploitation (23–24), religion, culture–education (29–30), constitutional remedies. Know which are available to citizens vs persons. Art 32 as “heart and soul” (Ambedkar) still appears.

Restrictions & exceptions

Art 19 reasonable restrictions grounds; Art 21 expanded jurisprudence (education, privacy — landmark awareness). Emergency effects historically important.

DPSP & interplay

Socialistic, Gandhian, liberal–intellectual principles classification helps memory. Conflict with FRs resolved toward harmonious construction in later doctrine — classic statement area.

Must remember

- Art 14–18 equality; 19 freedoms; 20–22 criminal process & life/liberty; 25–28 religion; 32 constitutional remedies
- DPSP Part IV non-justiciable but fundamental in governance
- Minerva Mills — harmony of FR & DPSP

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